



Jungseob Lee

NLP Researcher · Graduate Student, Korea University

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Summary

Integrated M.S./Ph.D. researcher at Korea University NLP Lab (Advisor: Prof. Heuseok Lim), working on large language models and natural language processing — agentic LLMs, efficient reasoning, machine translation, information retrieval, and model merging. First-author work at **EMNLP 2026** (Main), **ACL 2025** (Oral), and **Findings of ACL 2024**; four papers accepted at **EMNLP 2026** (2 Main, 2 Findings). Served as post-training Project Manager (Korea University representative) for **VAETKI**, Korea’s sovereign foundation model.

Research Interests: Large Language Models, Agentic LLM, Efficient Reasoning, Machine Translation, Information Retrieval, Model Merging

Education

Integrated M.S./Ph.D. in Computer Science

Korea University, Seoul, Korea

2021 – Present

Expected: Feb. 2027

- NLP Lab, Advisor: Prof. Heuseok Lim — large language models, agentic LLM, efficient reasoning, machine translation, information retrieval, and model merging

Research Experience

VAETKI — Korean Sovereign AI Foundation Model

Post-training Project Manager — Korea University Representative

Jun 2025 – Jan 2026

NC AI (NCSOFT)-led consortium

- Led the post-training pipeline (SFT, RL, dataset curation) as PM for Korea University; selected by the Ministry of Science and ICT for Korea’s national Sovereign AI Foundation Model program (NC AI-led 14-institution consortium; open-sourced Dec 2025).
- State-of-the-art on Korean language/culture (CLiCK), reasoning (KoBALT), professional knowledge (KMMLU-Pro), and instruction following (IFEval).
- [\[Model\]](#) [\[Technical Report\]](#)

Cross-lingual Language Transfer for Large Language Models

Lead Researcher (first author)

2024 – 2025

Published at ACL 2025 (Oral)

- Cross-lingual optimization that transfers English-centric LLMs to new languages while preserving source-language ability; **Oral** at ACL 2025.
- [\[PDF\]](#)

Length-aware Byte Pair Encoding for Korean Machine Translation

Lead Researcher (first author)

2024

Published at Findings of ACL 2024

- Length-aware BPE tokenization that mitigates over-segmentation in Korean machine translation and improves translation quality; **Findings of ACL 2024**.
- [\[PDF\]](#)

Awards & Honors

Outstanding Reviewer Award

2026

The 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL 2026), San Diego

Best Paper Award (Top 1)

2025

Annual Conference on Human and Cognitive Language Technology (HCLT 2025)

For “*KULLM-RAG: A RAG-Specialized Large Language Model with Intelligent Self-Verification*”; **J. Lee** (first author), M. Kim, J. Yoon, *et al.* — Korea University, Soongsil University, Human-Inspired AI Research.

Minister of Science and ICT Award

2023

ICT Challenge 2023, Ministry of Science and ICT (organized by IITP)

For “*KoCheckGPT*”, Korean-specialized detection of LLM-generated documents; team M. Kang, **J. Lee**, S. Lee — selected from 79 teams across 28 universities.

Publications

Underlined = me; * equal contribution. Full list (31 papers) on [Google Scholar](#).

2026

- “*The Hallucination Signal Is a Mean Shift: Why Simple Probes Suffice*” — **J. Lee**, J. Seo, H. Lim **EMNLP 2026** (Main) [\[arXiv\]](#)
- “*Language Chain in Alignment: Cross-Lingual Ranking Preference Optimization*” — S. Lee, M. Kim, **J. Lee**, H. Lim **EMNLP 2026** (Main)
- “*DART: Draft-Agreement Routing for Training-Free Adaptive Thinking Budgets in Hybrid Reasoning Models*” — **J. Lee**, S. Hong, S. Lee, *et al.* **Findings of EMNLP 2026** [\[arXiv\]](#)
- “*ThinkFuse: Trajectory-Aware Test-Time Fusion for Small Reasoning Models*” — M. Kang*, **J. Lee***, J. Seo, H. Lim **Findings of EMNLP 2026**
- “*Improving Semantic Proximity in Information Retrieval through Cross-Lingual Alignment*” — S. Hong, Y. Jang, **J. Lee**, H. Moon, H. Lim **ICLR 2026** (Poster) [\[PDF\]](#)
- “*Towards Enhancing Natural Language Inference for Identifying Erroneous Outputs in Data-to-Text Generation*” — C. Ok, E.K. Lee, H. Ju, **J. Lee**, D. Oh **Knowledge-Based Systems** [\[DOI\]](#)
- “*Beyond Penalizing Mistakes: Stabilizing Efficiency Training in Large Reasoning Models via Adaptive Correct-Only Rewards*” — **J. Lee**, S. Lee, S. Hong, M. Kim, C. Park, H. Lim Preprint [\[arXiv\]](#)
- “*To Isolate or to Score? Model-Adaptive Assessment for Cost-Efficient Multi-Agent RAG*” — **J. Lee**, C. Park, H. Lim Preprint [\[arXiv\]](#)
- “*Skin-Deep: A Geometric Diagnostic for Alignment Fragility in LLM Representations*” — D.J. Lee*, **J. Lee***, S. Lee, *et al.* **Findings of AACL-IJCNLP 2026** (*equal contribution) [\[arXiv\]](#)

2025

- “*Cross-lingual Optimization for Language Transfer in Large Language Models*” — **J. Lee**, S. Hong, H. Moon, H.S. Lim **ACL 2025** (Oral) [\[PDF\]](#)
- “*An Analysis on Language Transfer of Pre-trained Language Model with Cross-lingual Post-training*” — S. Son, C. Park, **J. Lee**, *et al.* **Expert Systems with Applications** [\[DOI\]](#)

2024

- “*Length-aware Byte Pair Encoding for Mitigating Over-segmentation in Korean Machine Translation*” — **J. Lee**, H. Moon, S. Lee, C. Park, S. Eo, *et al.* **Findings of ACL 2024** [\[PDF\]](#)
- “*Analysis of Model-, Data-, and User-Centric Approaches for Chat Applications: A Case Study of BlenderBot 2.0*” — C. Park, **J. Lee**, S. Son, *et al.* **Applied Sciences** [\[DOI\]](#)

2023

- “*A Survey on Evaluation Metrics for Machine Translation*” — S. Lee, **J. Lee**, H. Moon, *et al.* **Mathematics** (142 citations) [\[PDF\]](#)
- “*PEEP-Talk: A Situational Dialogue-based Chatbot for English Education*” — S. Lee, Y. Jang, C. Park, **J. Lee**, *et al.* **ACL 2023** (Demo) [\[PDF\]](#)

Last updated: September 16, 2026